

Kindness Art Competition 2026–27

Teacher's Guide

A simple, ready-to-run classroom project on the theme “Acts of Kindness — Big or Small.”

At a glance

Who	Students in grades 1–12 — individuals, classes, or whole schools
Theme	“Acts of Kindness — Big or Small”
Medium	Any 2D medium: pencil, crayon, watercolor, marker, digital, or mixed media
Cost	Free — unlimited classroom participation
Dates	Opens June 16, 2026 · Deadline March 31, 2027 · Winners Spring 2027
Prizes	Four First Prizes of \$500 (one per division) + Excellence Awards (1-yr Gan Jing Kids, \$120)
Showcase	Selected artwork featured on the Times Square billboard, NYC
Get started	Entry form & this guide: gjw.us/artentryform

Why bring this to your classroom

- **Builds character & empathy.** Students reflect on real acts of kindness and how they affect others.
- **Supports a positive, bully-free culture.** A shared, uplifting project the whole class can rally around.
- **Every student can take part.** It's about the idea, not artistic skill — there's no wrong way to show kindness.
- **Real recognition.** Winning art can appear on the Times Square billboard, with certificates for students, teachers, and schools.
- **Easy to run.** Works as a single lesson or a short unit, with everything you need below.

How to run it — 5 simple steps

- 1 Introduce the theme (≈10 min)** — Discuss what kindness means and why it matters. Use the prompts below to get students thinking.
- 2 Brainstorm (≈10 min)** — As a class, list acts of kindness — big and small. Encourage personal, real-life examples.
- 3 Create (main activity)** — Each student illustrates one act of kindness in any 2D medium. Encourage originality over polish.
- 4 Reflect & share (≈10 min)** — Students briefly share their artwork and the act of kindness it shows.
- 5 Submit** — Complete the entry form (parent/guardian signature required) and send by form, email, or mail.

Discussion prompts

- When has someone been kind to you? How did it make you feel?
- What is a small act of kindness anyone could do today?
- How can one act of kindness change a classroom — or a community?
- Who is someone you admire for being kind, and why?

Kindness ideas to spark artwork

Helping a classmate who's struggling · including someone who feels left out · standing up to bullying · caring for family · helping a neighbor or a stranger · protecting nature and animals · a kind word or a thank-you · a community clean-up · helping the elderly.

A guide by grade division

Division	Suggested approach	Prompt
Grades 1–3	A simple, personal moment of kindness in bright colors.	"Draw a time you helped someone."
Grades 4–6	A scene or short comic of kindness in action.	"Show kindness making someone's day better."
Grades 7–9	A poster or illustration with a clear message; try symbolism.	"Design art that inspires others to choose kindness."
Grades 10–12	A developed concept piece in any style or technique.	"Interpret the theme in your own artistic voice."

Submission checklist

- ☐ Original artwork on the theme "Acts of Kindness — Big or Small"
- ☐ Any 2D medium — for digital sending, a clear, well-lit photo or scan
- ☐ One entry per student
- ☐ Completed entry form with a parent/guardian signature
- ☐ Student initials, grade division, and school noted on the form
- ☐ Submitted by March 31, 2027

How to submit

- **Download** the entry form & this guide: gjw.us/artentryform
- **Email:** creators@ganjingworld.com
- **Mail:** 33 Fulton St, Middletown, NY 10940 (Attn: #BeKindBeCool)
- **Share online:** post on GanJingWorld.com with #BeKindBeCool to join the movement

Tips for teachers

- Photograph your class creating (with permission) — it's a great story to share.
- Display finished artwork in the classroom or hallway before submitting.
- Submit as a class in one email or envelope to save time.

- **Privacy:** for any public sharing, use student initials rather than full names — a parent/guardian signature is required on every entry.

Questions? We're here to help.

creators@ganjingworld.com · gjw.us/artentryform · bekindbecool.world

Let's keep spreading kindness — one action, one artwork, one heart at a time. #BeKindBeCool · Choose Kindness